Alabama Learning Hour

Introduce Yourself Part 2! Patient Verbs and Possession

October 15th, 2026

1 *Amoklaha* Text

Amoklaha

My Friends

Ava: Chaholchifaya Ava. Chiholchifak naasolĩ?
Jacob: Chaholchifaya Jacob.
Ava: Chikaanõ?
Jacob: Chakaanobi. Isnã?
Ava: Chakaanobi. Achayokpo.
Tanya: Hachikaano. Chaholchifaya Tanya. Hachiholchifaya naasolĩ?
Ava: Poholchifaya Ava, Jacob.
Tanya: Hachikaanõ?
Ava: Pokaanobi. Apoyokpo.

My Friends - English Translation

Ava: My name is Ava. What is your name?
Jacob: My name is Jacob.
Ava: How are you?
Jacob: I am good. You?
Ava: I am good. I'm happy.
Tanya: Hello y'all. My name is Tanya. What are y'all's names?
Ava: Our names are Ava and Jacob.
Tanya: How are y'all?
Ava: We are good. We are happy.

2 Vocabulary

New Words from the Dialogue

holchifa	name
chaholchifa	my name
chiholchifa	your name
poholchifa / **ko**holchifa	our names
hachiholchifa	y'all's names
kaano	to be good
ayokpa	to be happy

Talking about states

hoyapli	to be tired	nochiila	to be sleepy
hoopa	to be sick	małatli	to be scared
ilapalaali	to be angry	kayya	to be full (not hungry)
chaaha	to be tall	chakiiho	to be short

3 Recap: Patient Verbs

- Last week, we learnt about **patient verbs**.
- **Patient verbs** describe states of being, and actions which happen accidentally or without the subject's intention. The subject *undergoes* an action.
- For example:
- **kaano** 'to be good'
- **chaaha** 'to be tall'
- **ayokpa** 'to be happy'
- **hoyapli** 'to be tired'
- We started to learn to talk about how *you* feel or *I* feel.
- To do this, we need to add a *prefix* before the verb.

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

(1)

[Patient	+	Verb	+	Tense]
[cha-	+	hoyapl	+	o]
I		tired		STATE

Meaning: 'I'm tired.'

Patient Morphemes:

(2) *1st person singular — **I/me***
cha-
Example: **cha-kaano-bi**
'I'm good.'

(3) *2st person singular — **You***
chi-
Example: chi-kaanobi
'You are good.'

- **Reminder:** In the last couple of weeks, we learnt about the *o/bi* suffix, which describes the state that someone is currently experiencing.
- *-o* and *-bi* mean the same thing
  - *-o* appears on verbs that end with *a* or *i*, and the *a* and *i* is deleted: *hoyapli* "to be tired" → Ava *hoyaplo* "Ava is tired"
  - *-bi* appears on verbs that end with *o*: *kaano* → Ava *kaanobi* "Ava is good"

Repeat after me! *What does this mean? What do the pieces mean?*

kaano 'to be good'

(4) a. **cha-**kaano-**bi**
b. **chi-**kaano-**bi**
c. **Avak** kaano-**bi**

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

[Patient	+	Verb	+	Tense]	
[cha-	+	XX	+	o]	'I am XX'
[chi-	+	XX	+	o]	'You are XX'

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

nochiila 'to be sleepy'

(5) a. I am sleepy.
b. You are sleepy.
c. Ava is sleepy.

hoyapli 'to be tired'

(6) a. I am tired.
b. You are tired.
c. Ava is tired.

małatli 'to be scared'

(7) a. I am scared
b. You are scared
c. Ava is scared

hoopa 'to be sick'

(8) a. I am sick.
b. You are sick.
c. Ava is sick.

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

[**Patient**	+	**Verb**	+	**Tense**]	
[**cha-**	+	**XX**	+	**o**]	'I am XX'
[**chi-**	+	**XX**	+	**o**]	'You are XX'

★ **Careful!** If a verb begins with a vowel, the patient morpheme will do something special:

- Words beginning with **i-** will delete the i!
  ilaapalaali 'to be angry' → *cha-lapalaal-o* 'I'm angry'
- Words beginning with **a-** or **o-** will delete their first vowel, and put an **a-** before the patient marker.
  ayokpa 'to be happy' → *a-cha-yokp-o* 'I'm happy'

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

ilapalaali 'to be angry'
★ This word begins in a vowel!

(9) a. I am angry.
b. You are angry.
c. Ava is angry.

ayokpa 'to be happy'
★ This word begins in a vowel!

(10) a. I am happy.
b. You are happy.
c. Ava is happy.

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

[Patient	+	Verb	+	Tense]	
[cha-	+	XX	+	o]	'I am XX'
[chi-	+	XX	+	o]	'You are XX'

Repeat after me! *Let's practice a dialogue!*

- New Words: mahmin — 'but' chifoni — 'your sister'
  kankobi — 'not good' nochiilã — 'be sleepy'

A: **Chifoni kaanõ**?
B: Kankobi. **Hoop-o**.

A: Mahmin, **chikaanõ**? **chi-nochiilã**?

B: Ay, **cha-nochiil-o**.

A: **How is your sister**?
B: Good/Not good. She is **sick**.

A: But, how are you? Are **you sleepy**?

B: Yes, **I'm sleepy**.

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

[Patient	+	Verb	+	Tense]	
[cha-	+	XX	+	o]	'I am XX'
[chi-	+	XX	+	o]	'You are XX'

Grammar Practice: How are you?

- ***Let's Practice!*** *With a partner, talk about how someone is feeling. Replace Ex1 with the verb on the left, and Ex2 with the verb on the right.*
- New Words: 'Mahmin' — but Chifoni — 'Your sister'

A: **Chifoni kaanõ**?	A: **How is your sister**?
B: Kaanobi/Kankobi. [**EX1**]-**o**.	B: Good/Not good. She is [**EX1**].
A: Mahmin, **chikaanõ**? [**EX2**]?	A: But, how are you? Are **you** [**EX2**]?
B: Ay, [**EX2**]-**o**.	B: Yes, **I'm** [**EX2**].

1. EX1: ilapaali — angry, EX2: hoopa — sick
2. EX1: nochiila — sleepy, EX2: falanka — awake
3. EX1: hoopa — sick, EX2: małatli — scared
4. EX1: nokhammi — angry, EX2: ayokpa — happy

4 More Patients!

- Up to now, we have been learning how to talk about *myself* and *yourself*
- To talk about ourselves, and y'all-selves, it follows the same logic!
  - To talk about *ourselves*, use **ko-/po-**
    - **ko-kaano-o**, or **po-kaano-bi** " we are good"
  - To talk about *y'all-selves*, use **hachi-**
    - **hachi-kaano-bi** " y'all are good"

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe

(11)

[**Patient**	+	**Verb**	+	**Tense**]
[**cha-**	+	**hoyapl**	+	**o**]
I		tired		STATE

Meaning: 'I am tired.'

Patient Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	**cha-** 'my'	**ko-/po-** 'our'	*1st person = speaker*
2	**chi-** 'your'	**hachi-** 'y'all's'	*2nd person = addresse*
3		**(ho-)**	*3rd person = someone else*

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

nochiila 'to be sleepy'

(12)
a. I am sleepy.
b. You are sleepy.
c. Ava is sleepy.
d. We are sleepy.
e. Y'all are sleepy.

hoyapli 'to be tired'

(13)
a. I am tired.
b. You are tired.
c. Ava is tired.
d. We are tired
e. Y'all are tired.

małatli ‘to be scared’

(14)
a. I am scared
b. You are scared
c. Ava is scared
d. We are scared
e. Y’all are scared

hoopa ‘to be sick’

(15)
a. I am sick.
b. You are sick.
c. Ava is sick.
d. We are sick.
e. Y’all are sick.

5 Patient Possession

- In addition to talking about verbs, we can also talk about *nouns*, typically objects or things.
- When we talk about nouns, we may also want to talk about your relationship to those nouns, or *possession*.

(16)

my	**name**
POSSESSOR	

(17)

cha	+ **holchifa**
my	+ name
POSSESSSOR	

- It turns out that for some nouns, we use the **same morphemes** as we do for patient verbs to talk about possession!
- Unlike in English, in Alabama nouns differ in how their Possessors are expressed! Consider ‘my friend’ vs. ‘my name’:

(18)

am	+ **okla**
my	+ friend
POSSESSOR	

(19)

cha	+ **holchifa**
my	+ name
POSSESSSOR	

- Today we will talk about *cha*-Possessors, or Possessors I, which occur only with handful of nouns. We will save *am*-Possessors for later.
- To talk about *my* name, use **cha-**
  - **cha-** + **holchifa** = *chaholchifa* ‘my name’
- To talk about *your* name, use **chi-**
  - **chi-** + **holchifa** = *chiholchifa* ‘your name’
- To talk about *someone else’s* name, use their name or the noun itself

  - **Ava** + **holchifa** = *Ava holchifa* 'Ava's name'

- To talk about *our* names, use **ko-/po-**
  - **ko-/po-** + **holchifa** = *koholchifa* or *poholchifa* 'our name'
- To talk about *y'all's* names, use **hachi-**
  - **hachi-** + **holchifa** = *hachiholchifa* 'y'all's name'

Possessives I Easy Recipe

[**Possessor** + **Noun**]

Possessor Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	**cha-** 'my'	**ko-/po-** 'our'	*1st person = speaker*
2	**chi-** 'your'	**hachi-** 'y'all's'	*2nd person = addresse*
3	**noun** (e.g. *Ava*)	**noun** (e.g. *children*)	*3rd person = someone else*

- Put the Possessor to the left of the noun. If the possessor is 'my', 'you', 'our', or 'y'alls", it will become one word with the noun!
- Some families prefer to use *ko-* for 'our', some prefer *po-*. Choose whichever one you like (*or ask a family elder for a suggestion*)!

- For example, *sakba* means 'arm', so "my arm" is **cha-sakba**.
- If *halki* means 'wife', how would you say 'your wife'?
- If *hissi koloffi* means 'barber', how would you say 'Diego's barber'?

Possessives I Easy Recipe

[**Possessor** + **Noun**]

Possessor Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	**cha-** 'my'	**ko-/po-** 'our'	*1st person = speaker*
2	**chi-** 'your'	**hachi-** 'y'all's'	*2nd person = addresse*
3	**noun** (e.g. *Ava*)	**noun** (e.g. *children*)	*3rd person = someone else*

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

sakba 'arm'

(20) a. my arm
b. your arm
c. Ava's arm

sakba-ha 'arms'

(21) a. our arms
b. y'all's arms
c. children's arms *(posko-ha)*

halki 'wife'

(22) a. my wife
b. your wife
c. Diego's wife

halki-ha 'wives'

(23) a. our wives
b. y'all's wives
c. friends' (*okla-ha*) wives

hissi 'hair'

(24) a. my hair
b. your hair
c. Ava's hair
d. our hair
e. y'all's hair
f. children's hair *(posko-ha)*

(i)foni 'sister (of a man)'

(25) a. my sister
b. your sister
c. Diego's sister
d. our sister
e. y'all's sister
f. friends' sister *(okla-ha)*

6 Summary

- Today, we have learnt how to talk about *myself*, *yourself*, *ourselves*, and *y'all-selves* using patient verbs!
  - Some patient verbs we have learnt today include: *kaano* 'good', *hoy-apli* 'tired', and *hoopa* 'sick'
- We have also learnt about *possession* for some nouns in Alabama, to talk about *my*, *your*, *our*, and *y'all's* things. These used the same morphemes as we do for patient verbs!
  - Some nouns which take patient possession include: *holchifa* 'name', *halki* 'wife', and *hissi* 'hair'
- We also used *-o/-bi* on verbs to talk about the current state of being.